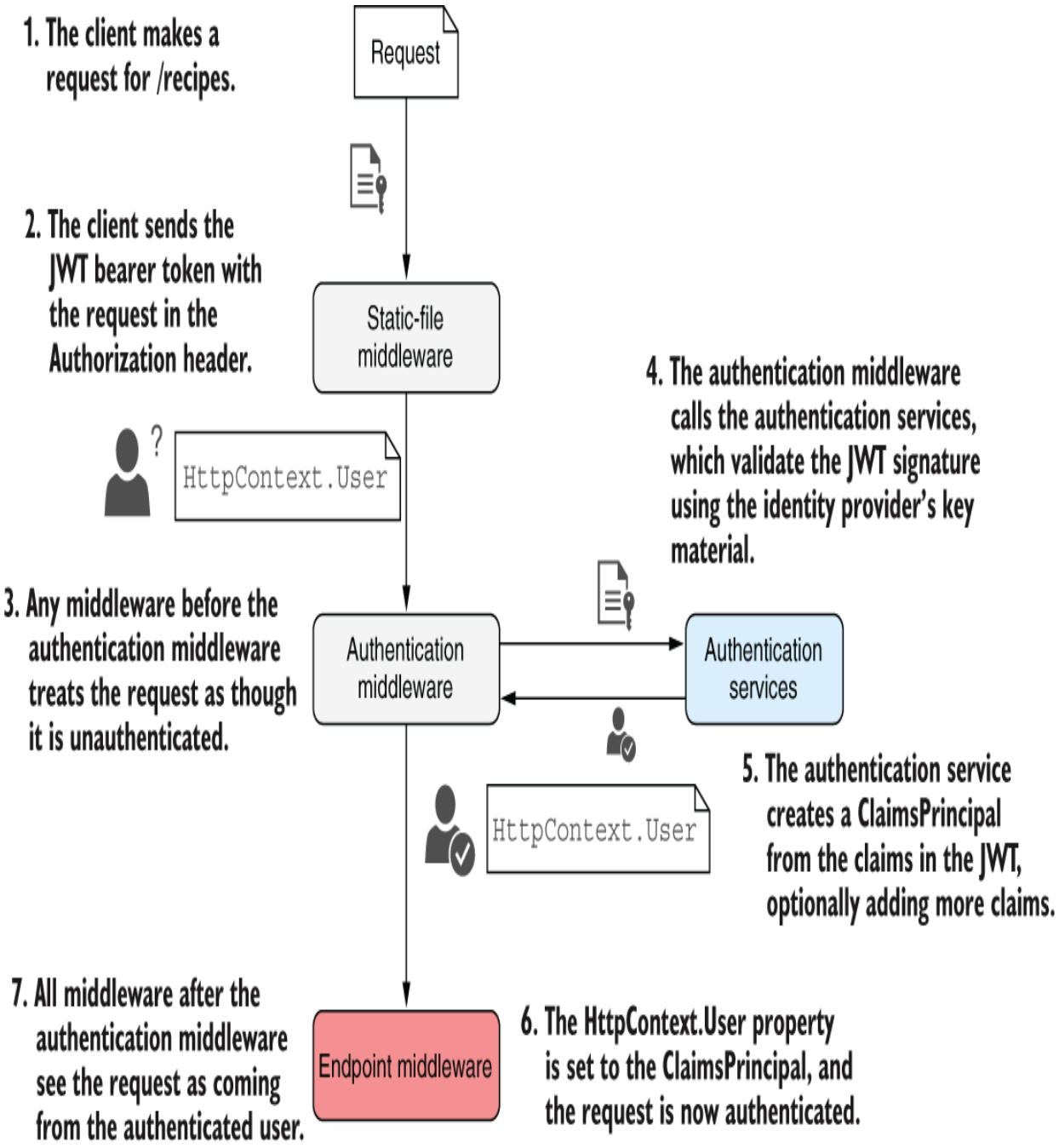


Figure 25.8 When an API request contains a bearer token, the token is validated and deserialized by the authentication middleware. The middleware creates a `ClaimsPrincipal` from the token, optionally transforming it with additional claims, and sets the `HttpContext.User` property. Subsequent middleware sees the request as authenticated.